Maranda L. Joyce

Contact Information

Rice University
Department of Political Science
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Houston, TX 77005

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Academic Positions

IE University, Madrid, Spain
Adjunct Professor of Public Policy, Summer & Fall 2026

Education

Rice University, Houston, TX
Ph.D., Political Science, May 2027 *(Expected)*
Dissertation: *Identity and Anti-Democratic Behavior in Local Politics*
Committee: Melissa Marschall, Tanika Raychaudhuri, Erik Peterson, Anna Rhodes
Graduate Certificate in Women, Gender, and Sexuality Studies
M.A., Political Science, May 2024

The University of Texas, Austin, TX
Master of Public Affairs, Data Science and Policy Analysis, May 2020
Focus in Evaluation Methods, Texas Women in Public Finance Scholarship Recipient

Southwestern University, Georgetown, TX
B.A., Economics and Business, May 2018
Economics Honors Student, Magna Cum Laude, Phi Beta Kappa

Research Interests

Political behavior, education policy, local politics, school choice, race and ethnicity, gender and politics, identity, public policy, youth and civic engagement

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Koch, Tabitha, **Maranda Joyce**, and Kishan Bhakta. "Unacceptable or Part of the Job? Measuring Public (In)Tolerance for Threats Against Women Politicians." ***Conditionally Accepted at Politics, Groups, and Identities.***

Under Review

Joyce, Maranda. "Homeschooling as Racial Retreat: The Impact of School District and Leadership Diversity." *Awarded the Best Paper in Education Politics and Policy Presented at the 2025 APSA Annual Meeting.*
Revised & Resubmitted at The Journal of Politics.

Peterson, Erik, Tyler Simko, **Maranda Joyce**, Josh McCrain, and Rachel White. "The Personnel Costs of Nationalization: Culture War Conflicts Lead to School Superintendent Turnover."

Joyce, Conner, **Maranda Joyce**, and Agustin Prinetti. "Bystanders on Social Media: Audience Moderation and the Spread of Online Extremism."

Works In Progress

Joyce, Maranda. "Selective Support: An Audit Study of Racial Gatekeeping in the Informal Homeschool Economy."

Joyce, Maranda, Tabitha Koch, Jonathan Homola, and Kishan Bhakta. "Politician Responses in the Aftermath of Violent Threats." *Awarded the Marian Irish Award for Best Women & Politics Paper Presented at the 2024 SPSA Annual Meeting.*

Marschall, Melissa, **Maranda Joyce**, and Wendy Rahn. "Do Appeals to Youth Identity Increase Turnout Among Young Voters? Results from a Field Experiment."

Joyce, Maranda. "Examining Threats Against Women Politicians: Is the Public Less Tolerant of Threats Against White Women?"

Joyce, Maranda, Marques Zarate, and Melissa Marschall. "Newest American Voters: Life Transitions, Sense of Belonging & Youth Civic Engagement."

Selected Professional Reports

Eaton, David, Heath Prince, **Maranda Joyce** et al. 2021. "Testing Methods for Austin Workforce Program Evaluation." *Awarded the James McGrew Research Award by the Central Texas Chapter of the American Society for Public Administration.*

Osborne, Cynthia, **Maranda Joyce**, and Jennifer Huffman. 2020. "Family Supports in a Pediatric Setting." *Policy Recommendations for People's Community Clinic.*

Grants and Awards

Rice Center for Women and Gender Studies Dissertation Fellowship ($7,500)	2026
Rice CIISR Research and Data Grant ($5,000)	2026
Rice Social Sciences Research Institute Dissertation Grant ($5,000)	2026
Rice Political Science Undergraduate Mentorship Grant ($1,250)	2026
APSA Best Education Politics and Policy Paper Award	2025
Rice Social Sciences Research Institute Pre-Dissertation Grant ($2,959)	2025
Rice CIISR Research and Data Computing Fellowship ($1,500)	2025
MPSA Pinderhughes Diversity PhD Student Travel Scholarship ($500)	2025
APSA Women, Gender & Politics Research Section Scholarship ($500)	2025
SPSA Marian Irish Award for Best Paper on Women & Politics	2024
PS-GSA Poli Seeds Collaborative Research Fund Recipient ($1,000)	2024
Polarization Research Lab Partisan Animosity Survey Time Sharing Grant	2023
Rice University Department of Political Science Graduate Fellowship	2022 - 2027

Work Experience

Research Assistant — Fall 2022 - Fall 2024
Melissa Marschall
Department of Political Science, Rice University

Graduate Student Policy Mentor — Fall 2022 - Spring 2024
Houston Action Research Team
Center for Civic Leadership, Rice University

Refugee Services Community Engagement Specialist — 2021 - 2022
The Alliance (Refugee Resettlement Agency)
Houston, Texas

Research Associate — 2020 - 2021
E3 Alliance (Education Research Nonprofit)
Austin, Texas

Social Policy Research Assistant — 2019 - 2020
Prenatal to Three Policy Impact Center (Early Ed Think Tank)
LBJ School of Public Affairs, UT Austin

Teaching Experience

Instructor

Comparative Politics and Ethics — Fall 2026
School of Politics, Economics, and Global Affairs, IE University

Introduction to Political Science — Summer 2026
School of Politics, Economics, and Global Affairs, IE University

Quantitative Analysis for Political Science — Fall 2025
Department of Political Science, Rice University

Teaching Assistant

Social Statistics in R Summer 2026
Research for Undergraduate Experiences, Rice University

Programming Support for Theses & Advanced Seminars Spring 2026
Department of Political Science, Rice University

First Year Writing Intensive: Cowboys and Cornfields Fall 2025
Program in Writing and Communication, Rice University

Introduction to U.S. Elections Fall 2024
Department of Political Science, Rice University

Presentations and Invited Workshops

2026: SPSA, Madrid Empirical Social Sciences Annual Conference
2025: SPSA, WPSA (*Presented by Coauthors*), MPSA, APSA
2024: SPSA, APSA (*Presented by Coauthors*)
2023: APSA

Service

Center for Civic Leadership, Rice University
Rice Votes Graduate Student Representative (April 2023 - April 2025)

Political Science Graduate Student Association, Rice University
Professional Development Coordinator (April 2023 - April 2024)

Rice Department of Political Science
American Politics Workshop Coordinator (May 2024 - December 2025)

Reviewer
Journal of Politics

Skills

Programming: R, LaTeX, Qualtrics, STATA, Python, SAS, Mathematica

Affiliations

American Political Science Association
Southern Political Science Association
Midwestern Political Science Association
Phi Beta Kappa
AmeriCorps Alums